UX / UI CASE STUDY · EDTECH · CONCEPT PROJECT

Lingua Path

Designing a Career English Learning Platform for Professionals

PLATFORM
Mobile App + Web Dashboard + Mentor Layer

ROLE
UX/UI Designer — End to End

FOCUS
EdTech · Adult Learning · Professional Communication

TYPE
Concept project — Portfolio case study

DURATION
4 weeks

DELIVERABLES
Research · IA · Flows · Wireframes · UI Direction

01 — PROJECT OVERVIEW

What is LinguaPath?

LinguaPath is a hybrid EdTech platform built for adult professionals who understand English but lack the confidence to use it in high-stakes workplace situations — meetings, interviews, presentations, and cross-cultural collaboration.

The platform brings together three surfaces: a structured **mobile app** for daily practice, a **web dashboard** for learning planning and progress review, and a **mentor support layer** that provides the human feedback most digital language tools skip entirely.

Unlike consumer language apps optimised for streaks and casual engagement, LinguaPath treats its users as goal-driven adults. Every design decision — from the learning roadmap to the mentor booking flow — was made to serve one outcome: helping professionals communicate with confidence in real work situations.

The three gaps this product addresses

- The absence of structured career-focused content in mainstream language apps
- The lack of visible, multi-dimensional progress tracking
- The missing human feedback layer that builds real communicative confidence

The three-surface approach

- **Mobile:** daily practice sessions, short and focused
- **Web dashboard:** progress review and learning planning
- **Mentor layer:** guided feedback at key progression checkpoints

02 — THE PROBLEM

The Intermediate Plateau

Millions of professionals have reached a functional level of English. They can follow conversations, read documents, and understand most of what they hear. But when it's their turn to speak in a meeting, write a difficult email, or present to an international audience — they freeze.

This is known in language acquisition research as the **intermediate plateau**: a stage where passive comprehension exists but active production lags far behind. The learner has enough English to get by, but not enough confidence to perform under pressure.

> *"I understand everything in the meetings, but when it's my turn to speak, I go blank. I sound competent in Portuguese — not in English."*

Where existing platforms fall short

Most language apps are built around engagement mechanics — streaks, points, short exercises, and gamified reward loops. These are effective at creating habits, but they address the wrong problem for this audience. Adult professionals are not struggling with motivation. They are struggling with structure, context, and confidence.

What existing apps do well

- Vocabulary building and grammar reinforcement
- Daily habit formation through streaks
- Accessible and low-friction entry for beginners

Where they fall short

- Lessons lack professional workplace context
- No structured progression for intermediate learners
- Progress measured in streaks, not skill growth
- No human feedback layer for communication practice

03 — TARGET USERS

Who this product is for

LinguaPath is designed for adult professionals at the intermediate level — people who have studied English before and can function in English, but who need to perform in it consistently and confidently at work.

Remote workers

Collaborating daily with international colleagues via async tools, video calls, and written communication

Career switchers

Moving into global companies or international roles where English is the primary working language

Interview candidates

Preparing for English-language hiring processes at international or multinational organisations

Intermediate learners

Stuck at a plateau — they understand English well but freeze when active communication is required

04 — RESEARCH INSIGHTS

What the research revealed

Research combined direct observation from ten years of teaching professional English learners, competitive analysis of major language learning platforms, and review of adult learning literature. Five consistent patterns shaped every design decision.

Research inputs: observation of adult learner patterns · platform competitive analysis · professional teaching experience · review of challenges in international workplace transitions

#	Insight	Design implication
1	**Adult learners are goal-driven**	Every screen connects directly to a declared career goal. The learning path is generated from a specific outcome, not an open topic library.
2	**Visible progress sustains motivation**	Progress must be multi-dimensional. A single completion percentage is not enough — learners need to see improvement across specific communication skills over time.
3	**Real-world context increases engagement**	Lessons must simulate professional scenarios — meetings, status updates, emails, presentations. Generic vocabulary drills are disengaging for this audience.
4	**Structure reduces abandonment**	Adult learners stay engaged longer when the experience has a clear roadmap and defined endpoint. Open content libraries increase drop-off at the intermediate stage.
5	**Mentor feedback builds real confidence**	The gap between passive understanding and active communication cannot be closed through practice alone. Human feedback from a qualified guide is a critical accelerator.

05 — PERSONAS

User personas

Both personas were developed from direct teaching experience with professional learners across ten years, combined with analysis of recurring learner archetypes observed in different industries and contexts.

Mariana Costa, 34

Marketing Analyst · São Paulo, Brazil · B1–B2 English · Primary persona

Background	Works at a mid-size company with growing regional responsibilities. Her team recently joined a cross-functional project with US and UK colleagues. She was passed over for a promotion she believes she lost partly due to her English communication hesitation.
Goals	Perform confidently in weekly international meetings. Write professional emails without second-guessing her tone. Secure a regional promotion within 12 months.
Frustrations	Casual apps feel juvenile. No feedback on whether she's actually improving. Lesson content uses travel scenarios, not workplace ones.

Daniel Osei, 28

Software Developer · Accra, Ghana · B2 English · Secondary persona

Background	Self-taught developer applying to remote positions at international companies. Technical interviews go well but he struggles with written communication rounds and async tools like Slack and Notion.
Goals	Land a remote role within 6 months. Communicate clearly in async written environments. Build professional vocabulary for cross-cultural collaboration.
Frustrations	Most resources focus on spoken English, not professional writing. No structured path — piecing together YouTube, apps, and books. No one reviews his writing honestly.
Behaviour	Highly self-directed. Learns in the evenings and weekends. Prefers

Behaviour	Learns in 15–20 min sessions during lunch or evenings. Reviews progress on weekends via web. Values accountability and measurable milestones.
Quote	*"I understand everything in the meetings, but when it's my turn to speak, I go blank."*

	written practice at this stage. Motivated by direct application to job applications.
Quote	*"My technical skills are solid. But my written English needs work — especially for async remote teams."*

06 — USER JOURNEY

Career English learner journey

The journey map traces a professional learner from initial motivation through to confident real-world application. It informed which moments in the product experience needed the most design attention.

	Motivation	Discovery	Onboarding	Learning	Feedback	Growth
User actions	Realises English is necessary for career growth or remote work	Searches for solutions, compares platforms	Creates account, selects goals, completes skill assessment	Completes daily lessons, practises scenarios	Reviews progress, books mentor sessions	Applies English confiden in meetin interview collabora
Pain points	Feels behind professionally. Doesn't know which path is right.	Products seem generic, childish, or too streak-focused	Unsure about their level or where to begin	Loses motivation if content feels repetitive or disconnected	Without guidance, doesn't know how to improve weak areas	May still f insecure high-pressure situation
Opportunities	Clear value proposition focused on professional communication	Highlight structured paths, workplace scenarios, mentor support	Guided onboarding with personalised roadmap creation	Contextual lessons built around real workplace scenarios	Translate mentor feedback into clear next actions	Reinforce confiden with milestone tracking goal completi

07 — PRODUCT STRATEGY

Core product principles

Instead of designing a traditional language learning app focused on vocabulary and repetition, the goal was to create a structured professional development tool. Each decision — from the learning roadmap to the mentor layer — reinforces clarity, progress visibility, and real-world communication practice.

01

Structure over abundance

A defined learning path rather than an overwhelming library of lessons. Learners always know what comes next.

02

Context over coverage

Lessons built around real workplace situations: meetings, emails, interviews, and presentations.

03

Feedback as a product feature

Mentor support integrated into the learning journey as a core differentiator, not an optional extra.

04

Progress visibility

The dashboard shows learners how their specific communication skills are evolving over time.

08 — INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

Platform structure

LinguaPath is a three-surface product. Each surface has a distinct role in the learning journey and serves a different user need.

Mobile App

Daily learning experience. Short, focused sessions for commutes and lunch breaks. All core lesson content and the primary learning loop.

Web Dashboard

Progress tracking and learning planning. Learners review skill growth, view their roadmap, and access mentor session history on a larger canvas.

Mentor Layer

Human feedback and guided review. Matched by specialisation. Woven into the learning path at key milestone checkpoints — not an optional add-on.

Mobile app navigation

Section	Sub-screens	Purpose
Onboarding (one-time)	Goal setup, skill assessment	Establish learning contract and communication baseline
Home (tab 1)	Today's lesson, module progress, mentor reminder	Daily habit surface and re-entry point
Learn (tab 2)	Modules, lessons, practice scenarios	Core content and skill-building sessions
Mentor (tab 3)	Session booking, feedback history	Human support and guided feedback layer
Progress (tab 4)	Skill scores, activity log	Mobile view of learning analytics

Web dashboard navigation

Section	Purpose
Overview	Dashboard landing: 3 metric cards, skill radar chart, activity feed, recommended next action
My Path	Full roadmap: all modules with status, estimated durations, locked/unlocked progression
Progress	Detailed skill progress: 6-week charts per dimension, contributing sessions, mentor feedback excerpts
Mentorship	Session booking calendar, mentor profiles by specialisation, session history, feedback log
Account	Goals, subscription, notification preferences, profile settings

09 — USER FLOWS

User flows

Flow 1 — Onboarding to first lesson

Target: under 8 minutes from sign-up to first lesson · Platform: mobile app · Context: new user

#	User action	System response
1	Downloads app and creates account (email or social auth)	Welcome screen shown. Step indicator appears (1 of 3).
2	Selects primary goal from 4 options	Goal is stored. Step advances. CTA activates.
3	Completes 5 situational assessment questions	Each selection auto-advances. No timer shown. 'No wrong answers' message displayed.
4	Reviews generated personalised learning path	Roadmap shown: 5 modules, ~8 weeks, Module 1 highlighted as current.
5	Taps 'Start Module 1'	First lesson loads. Progress bar initialises at Step 1 of 5.
6	Reads scenario card and completes first task	Tip available on request. Character count shown. Submit activates on entry.
7	Submits response and completes first lesson	Completion screen shown. Module progress updates. Home tab reflects new state.

Flow 2 — Progress review to mentor support

Platform: web dashboard → mobile app · Context: returning user, Week 2

#	User action	System response
1	Opens web dashboard and navigates to Progress	Overview loads: metric cards, skill radar chart, recent activity feed.
2	Notices low 'Speaking clarity' score on radar chart	Recommendation strip surfaces: 'A mentor session could accelerate your progress.'

#	User action	System response
3	Clicks into Skills Detail for Speaking Clarity	6-week chart shown. Contributing sessions listed. Mentor feedback excerpt visible.
4	Clicks 'Book mentor session'	Mentor booking loads. Mentors filtered by 'Workplace speaking.'
5	Selects session type and a time slot	CTA updates dynamically: 'Confirm — Fri 6:00 PM.'
6	Confirms booking	Confirmation shown. Session added to calendar. Prep materials card surfaced.
7	Attends session and receives mentor feedback	Notes saved to feedback log. Skill score updates. Recommended next lesson appears.

10 — KEY SCREENS

Product screens — MVP

8 core screens across mobile and web. Each screen is designed around a single primary action, a clear information hierarchy, and a direct connection to the learner's declared career goal.

Mobile · Onboarding · Step 1

01 — Goal Selection

Establishes the learner's contract with the product. The goal selected here determines module content, lesson types, vocabulary register, and mentor specialisation matching. Must feel like a professional intake — not a quiz.

CORE COMPONENTS

- Step indicator (3 dots, active/inactive)
- Headline + sub-headline
- 4 tappable goal cards (icon + label + description)
- Secondary link: 'I have more than one goal'
- Primary CTA: 'Continue' — disabled until selection

UX RATIONALE

Single-question forced-choice reduces cognitive load and increases completion. Disabling the CTA prevents skipping the step that determines the entire learning path. The professional framing signals from the first screen that this is not a casual app.

Mobile · Onboarding · 5 questions

02 — Skill Assessment

Establishes a communication baseline using situational workplace prompts rather than grammar exercises. This signals from the very first question that the product is about real communication, not textbook English.

CORE COMPONENTS

- Progress bar (question X of 5)

UX RATIONALE

Auto-advance on selection removes a tap and keeps momentum. The 'no wrong answers' framing reduces evaluation anxiety — a common barrier for

- Scenario context card (teal fill, overline label)
- Question prompt (16px, medium weight)
- 4 answer rows with radio indicators
- Hint: 'No wrong answers — this calibrates your path'

intermediate learners already self-conscious about their English ability.

Mobile · Post-onboarding reveal

03 — Personalised Learning Roadmap

The payoff screen. The user sees their complete learning path for the first time — structured progression from current level to declared goal. Must feel personal and achievable simultaneously.

CORE COMPONENTS

- Header: user name + goal + duration badge (~8 weeks)
- Overall progress bar (4px, labeled)
- Vertical milestone timeline with connecting spine
- 5 module cards: active / upcoming / locked states
- Module 5: purple mentor milestone indicator
- Sticky CTA: 'Start Module 1'

UX RATIONALE

The roadmap solves the most common driver of abandonment: 'how long will this take?' going unanswered. Showing the complete path with a time estimate gives learners an answer before they ask. Locked-state progression makes advancement feel earned, not punitive.

Mobile · Recurring · 4-tab navigation

04 — Daily Learning Home

The surface the user returns to every day. Must answer three questions instantly: Where am I? What should I do today? How am I doing? It is a launching pad, not a content library.

CORE COMPONENTS

- Header: greeting with name + avatar circle
- Module progress bar + sub-label

UX RATIONALE

A single dominant CTA removes choice paralysis for returning users. The weekly activity strip communicates practice consistency without the

- Featured 'Today's lesson' card (teal 1.5px border)
- Meta: duration icon + lesson type label
- Primary CTA: 'Continue lesson'
- Weekly activity strip (7 day dots)
- Mentor reminder card (conditional)
- Tab bar: Home / Learn / Mentor / Progress

anxiety mechanics of a streak counter that 'breaks' when a day is missed.

Mobile · Focused task flow · Tab bar hidden

05 — Lesson Screen

The core product experience. Every design decision supports one goal: practising real professional communication in a realistic workplace context, without distraction.

CORE COMPONENTS

- Exit button (left) + step counter (right)
- Lesson progress bar (step-level, not module)
- Lesson type chip (written / spoken / scenario choice)
- Scenario context card (teal-50, 'Workplace scenario')
- Task prompt (15px, medium weight)
- Response area: textarea / choices / mic button
- 'Show tip' ghost button + 'Submit' primary button

UX RATIONALE

The scenario card grounds every task in professional reality. Hiding the tip by default preserves productive cognitive effort while ensuring no learner feels stranded. Removing points and timers keeps focus on communication quality, not speed.

Mobile · Mentor tab

06 — Mentor Booking

Where the human layer becomes tangible. The design communicates trust, specificity, and ease. The learner has just identified a skill gap — booking should feel like a natural next step.

CORE COMPONENTS

- Page header: 'Book a session' + '60-minute guided review'
- Mentor profile card: avatar, name, spec tag, bio, stats
- Session type selector: 3 radio rows
- 6-column weekly availability grid
- Dynamic CTA: 'Confirm — Fri 6:00 PM'

UX RATIONALE

Showing the mentor's specialisation before the calendar confirms this is a matched professional. The session type selector connects the booking directly to the learner's current skill gap, making the session feel purposeful before it starts.

Web · Sidebar navigation

07 — Progress Overview Dashboard

The central web view. Translates all learning activity into a clear picture of communication skill growth. A learner should understand their status within 30 seconds of arriving.

CORE COMPONENTS

- Fixed sidebar: brand, navigation (5 items), sign out
- Page greeting + module context sub-label
- 3-column metric strip: lessons / module / days active
- Skill radar chart (5 axes)
- 2-col: radar (left) + activity feed (right)
- Full-width recommended action strip

UX RATIONALE

The radar chart is the most important design decision. It replaces a single progress percentage with a multi-dimensional view of communication skill. A learner who scores well on Writing but low on Speaking sees that asymmetry immediately — and knows exactly what to focus on.

Web · Progress drill-down

08 — Skills Progress Detail

The deep-dive view. When a learner selects a skill dimension, they see how it has changed over 6 weeks, which sessions contributed, and what their mentor said. This screen makes the product's premium value most visible.

CORE COMPONENTS

UX RATIONALE

- 5-tab skill selector (one per dimension)
- Score display: large number + change indicator
- 6-week progress line chart (full-width)
- Contributing sessions table (left column)
- Mentor feedback excerpt with left-border quote block
- Recommended next action strip

The mentor feedback excerpt is the most powerful element on this screen. Seeing a professional's specific observation — 'she tends to trail off before finishing key points' — is what converts a sceptical learner into a committed one. It is also the clearest signal that LinguaPath offers something no automated app can replicate.

10B — WIREFRAMES

Low-fidelity layout structure

Wireframes were developed zone by zone, top to bottom. Each zone has a defined height, content type, and interaction state. The consistent three-zone pattern across all mobile screens reduces cognitive switching as learners move between screens.

Screen 4 — Daily Home

Header *greeting + avatar · 56px*

Module progress bar *label + 4px bar + sub-label*

Today's lesson card (featured) *teal 1.5px border · chip + title + meta + CTA · ~140px*

Weekly activity strip *7 day dots · filled / today / empty*

Mentor reminder (conditional) *only shown if session booked within 7 days*

Tab bar: Home · Learn · Mentor · Progress *fixed · 52px*

Screen 5 — Lesson Screen

Exit button + step counter *44px · NO tab bar*

Lesson progress bar (step-level) *3px · teal fill*

Lesson type chip *icon + label · bordered pill*

Scenario context card *teal-50 bg · SCENARIO overline · 80–100px*

Task prompt *15px · weight 500 · 2 lines*

Response textarea *min-height 100px · focus: teal border + teal ring*

Char count + 'Show tip' + Submit *ghost btn + primary btn · 44px row*

Screen 7 — Progress Dashboard (Web)

Layout: fixed left sidebar (200px) + main content area · min viewport 1280px

Sidebar: brand + tagline *200px fixed · teal brand name*

Page greeting + sub-label *18px 500 + 13px muted*

3-col metric strip *gray-100 bg · 64px each · label + value + sub*

Nav: Progress (active) *teal-50 bg · 2px teal left border*

Nav: My Path / Mentorship / Account *hover state · 36px each*

Sign out *margin-top auto · bottom of sidebar*

2-col: Skill radar (left) + Activity feed (right) *equal width · ~180px · 5-axis polygon / 4–5 feed items*

Recommended action strip (full-width) *teal-50 bg · text + mentor CTA · 48px*

11 — UI DESIGN DIRECTION

Visual design direction

Brand personality

Structured · Purposeful · Confident · Calm · Credible · Human · Focused

Color direction

Three semantic color ramps anchor the system. Teal carries all primary learning interactions. Purple is reserved exclusively for the mentor layer. Amber appears only at milestone moments, preserving its signal value.

Teal 400 — Primary CTA	#1D9E75	Primary buttons, active navigation, progress fills, selected states
Teal 600 — Interactive	#0F6E56	Labels on teal fills, section labels, hover states
Teal 50 — Surface	#E1F5EE	Scenario cards, selected states, recommendation strips
Purple 600 — Mentor	#534AB7	All mentor-related CTAs, booking button, mentor tags
Purple 50 — Mentor surface	#EEEDFE	Mentor card fills, session type selected state
Amber 400 — Milestone	#BA7517	Milestone markers only — use very sparingly
Gray 800 — Primary text	#2C2C2A	Headings, key labels, all primary text
Gray 50 — Background	#F7F6F3	Page background, secondary surfaces, metric card fills

Typography

Recommended typeface: **DM Sans**. A humanist geometric sans-serif with excellent legibility at small sizes and a warm, professional quality at display sizes. The 300 weight for display headings creates openness; the 500 weight for UI labels communicates structure without heaviness.

Role	Size	Weight	Usage
Display headline	36–52px	Light 300	Onboarding headlines, dashboard welcome messages
Section heading	20–28px	Medium 500	Screen headings, module names, card titles
Body text	14–15px	Regular 400	Lesson content, scenario cards, descriptions
UI label / CTA	13–15px	Medium 500	Buttons, navigation, CTAs
Caption / overline	10–11px	Regular 400	Metadata, overlines (uppercase + letter-spacing)

What to avoid

CHILDISH GAMIFICATION

- × Streak fire icons and daily point tallies
- × Confetti animations on lesson completion
- × Animated mascots or illustrated characters
- × Level-up badges on the home screen

UNPROFESSIONAL VISUAL PATTERNS

- × Bright saturated multi-color palettes
- × Rounded 'bubbly' typography
- × Timers or point counters during lessons
- × Multiple competing CTAs on one screen

12 — EXPECTED OUTCOMES

Expected outcomes

The following outcomes are projections based on the product design decisions and comparable EdTech benchmarks. Clearly labelled as expected — no fabricated metrics are used.

Clearer learning progression

A user completing onboarding as designed would reach their first lesson within 8 minutes of sign-up, with a specific goal selected and a clear 8-week roadmap generated. This reduces the 'I don't know where to start' drop-off that drives early abandonment in language apps.

Improved learner confidence in professional communication

A learner using the structured roadmap for 4 weeks would complete 2–3 modules, have at least one mentor session, and be able to name specific improvement areas from their skill profile — rather than the vague 'I've been practising' feeling most apps produce.

Stronger transfer to workplace communication

Because every lesson is framed by a professional scenario before the task, learners would be expected to transfer practice skills more readily to real workplace situations compared to context-free vocabulary drills.

Visible, multi-dimensional skill growth

The radar chart translates learning activity into a view of communication ability that maps to how language actually works. Learners who can see their Writing score improving while Speaking needs work engage more deliberately — and feel a greater sense of progress.

Increased engagement through real-world scenarios and mentor support

Retention for motivated adult professionals would be expected to outperform casual gamified apps because the product is designed around their actual goal — career advancement — rather than engagement loops and daily streaks.

13 — REFLECTION

Reflection

> *My ten years as an English instructor gave me something most UX designers working in EdTech don't have: I know what it actually feels like to be in the room with a struggling intermediate learner.*

What teaching gave this design

I have watched professionals who speak three languages freeze the moment they switch to English in front of an international audience. I have seen learners who can pass a grammar test stumble through a job interview. For ten years, I designed learning materials that had to work in the real world — not just look good in a presentation.

This background shaped every design decision in LinguaPath. The problem statement came from something I observed directly. The personas reflect composite portraits of real learners. The scenario-based lesson structure comes from a pedagogical approach I used in adult classrooms — situational learning is significantly more effective for professional communication than decontextualised grammar drills. The mentor layer exists because I know from experience that feedback from a qualified person is irreplaceable.

What UX design added

Transitioning into UX showed me that learning experience design and product design share more than they appear to. Both require deep empathy. Both require clear information architecture — knowing what comes first, what comes next, and why. Both require making complex things feel simple without removing the substance.

The difference is that UX design makes those decisions visible, testable, and iteratable. A curriculum designer says 'I think this lesson sequence works.' A UX designer can define the hypothesis, design the flow, test it, measure abandonment, and revise. That loop is more honest and more powerful.

What this project represents

LinguaPath is a design response to a real problem I have spent a decade watching go unsolved — the gap between passive English competence and confident professional communication. The research insights

are real. The personas are grounded in actual learners. The design decisions are rooted in what I know about how adults learn under pressure.

That is the contribution I bring to any product team working in EdTech: a designer who does not just research the user — but who has been in the room with them for ten years.

LinguaPath

Designing a Career English Learning Platform for Professionals · UX/UI Case Study · Concept Product Design · End-to-End Design